



12-Day Storytelling Practice Challenge Guide

Build your clarity, confidence, and storytelling skills—one minute at a time.

How this works

For the next 12 days, you will complete one short storytelling challenge each day. Each activity takes 1 minute to record and 3–5 minutes to prepare.

Daily instructions

1. Find a quiet spot with decent lighting.
2. Use your phone or laptop camera.
3. Hit record and speak naturally.
4. Keep your video between 60–75 seconds.
5. Save your video so you can review progress.

Daily challenges

Day 1: Cloud in a post

Goal: Explain cloud or IoT in basic terms, like a social media post.

Record: You will record a 1-minute explanation of *one thing you learned* in the course, but explain it as though you're talking to someone who *doesn't know tech*.

Tips:

- Use plain language.
- Avoid acronyms or explain them.
- Test: Would a non-technical friend understand your explanation?

Day 2: Explain to a young teenager

Goal: Strip away jargon.

Record: You will record a 1-minute explanation of any project (IoT, dashboard, sensors). Pretend the listener is a *young teenager*.

Tips:

- Use examples, such as, “It works like a motion-activated light...”.

- Do not use technical terms unless you explain them.

Day 3: Explain to a recruiter

Goal: Business impact and relevance.

Record: You will record a 1-minute, recruiter-friendly explanation of the *same project* from Day 2 (*the young teenager explanation*).

Tips:

- Focus on the *problem*, the *solution*, and the *impact*.
- Connect it to *user experience*, efficiency, savings, or safety.
- Keep it high-level.

Day 4: STAR in 60 seconds

Goal: Practice structured storytelling.

Record: You will record a 1-minute STAR story using the following:

- Situation
- Task
- Action
- Result

Tips:

- Choose a small, practical experience.
- Make your Result measurable (For example: “We reduced wait time by 10 minutes”).

Day 5: The mature adult test

Goal: Make complex tech feel human.

Record: Explain IoT or cloud computing as though you're talking to a *mature adult* (or someone with no tech background).

Tips:

- Use metaphors (the cloud is like online storage you can access anywhere).

- Keep sentences short.

Day 6: Smart campus story

Goal: Tell a story with clear impact.

Record: Explain one smart campus solution using the following:

- The *problem*
- The *solution*
- The *impact*

Examples:

- Energy savings
- Shuttle overcrowding
- Classroom safety
- Access control

Day 7: Translate jargon

Goal: Recognize and remove jargon instinctively.

Record:

- **Part 1 (20 seconds):** Give a jargon-heavy explanation of something technical.
- **Part 2 (40 seconds):** Re-explain it in *plain language*.

Tips:

- Notice when your explanation becomes *tech-first*.
- Fix it by making it *human-first*.

Day 8: Troubleshooting story

Goal: Practice behavioral interviewing.

Record: You will record a 1-minute story about a time you solved a technical or teamwork problem.

Tips:

- Keep it small, such as a bug you fixed, a miscommunication, or a setup issue.
- End with the *impact*.

Day 9: User experience first

Goal: Connect tech to people.

Record: Explain one technical feature *only from the user's perspective*.

Do not use technical terms.

Example:

Instead of *sensor triggers automation*, say, “When no one is in the room, the lights turn off automatically.”

Day 10: Why this matters

Goal: Show business relevance.

Record: Choose one of the following concepts and explain *why* it matters to a school, business, or community:

- Sensors
- Dashboards
- Cloud storage
- Alerts
- Automation

Tip:

- Focus on money saved, time saved, safety, or quality of life.

Day 11: Brief introduction

Goal: Sharpen your self-introduction.

Record: You will record a 30–60 second brief introduction (ideally you have refined the one you created during the workshop), including the following:

- Who you are
- What you've done
- What skills you bring
- What you're looking for

Tip:

- Imagine you're talking to a hiring manager in an elevator.

Day 12: Describe a data flow (without architecture words)

Goal: Clarity without over-explaining.

Record: Explain a basic flow (sensor, cloud, and dashboard) *without* words like *pipeline*, *ingest*, *microservice*, *MQTT*, and so on.

Example:

A device sends information to the cloud, where it's stored and shown on a dashboard so people can see it instantly.